

ABC INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

Hiranandani Gardens, Powai, Mumbai – 400 076

CBSE (Pre-Primary – XII) | Cambridge IGCSE (Gr. 9–10)

STAFF LEAVE POLICY

Comprehensive Leave Management Document

Academic Year	2025 – 26	Board	CBSE / Cambridge IGCSE
Document Cat.	HR / Category 5	Applicable To	All Staff Categories
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This document constitutes the official and comprehensive Leave Policy for all staff members of ABC International School, Powai. It supersedes all previous leave-related communications and must be read in conjunction with the Employee Handbook and applicable Indian labour legislation.

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1. Policy Overview & Scope

ABC International School, Powai, recognises that a well-structured and transparent leave policy is essential for staff well-being, institutional productivity and statutory compliance. This policy has been prepared in accordance with the Shops and Establishments Act (Maharashtra), the Maternity Benefit Act 1961, the Payment of Gratuity Act 1972, and all other applicable Central and State labour legislation.

The policy applies to all individuals employed with ABC International School, Powai, regardless of designation, department or board (CBSE / IGCSE). Any conflict between the provisions of this policy and applicable law shall be resolved in favour of the law, and the HR Department shall issue a corrigendum within 30 days of such identification.

Key Objectives

- Provide adequate, fair and equitable leave to all staff categories.
- Ensure minimum disruption to academic and administrative operations.
- Maintain full compliance with national and state labour laws.
- Define clear processes for application, approval, record-keeping and encashment.
- Serve as an authoritative knowledge-base for the school's institutional chatbot.

2. Staff Categories Covered

The leave entitlements under this policy differ based on staff category. The following categories are recognised:

Category	Includes	Employment Type
Teaching Staff	Class Teachers, Subject Teachers, Specialist Teachers, TGTs, PGTs, PRTs, Nursery Teachers	Permanent / Probationary
Academic Leadership	Academic Coordinators, Head of Departments, Vice Principal, Principal	Permanent
Non-Teaching Staff	Lab Assistants, Librarians, Counsellors, Sports Coaches, Activity Coordinators	Permanent / Probationary
Administrative Staff	Admissions Officers, Accounts Executives, HR Executives, IT Staff, Receptionists, Office Assistants	Permanent / Probationary
Support Staff	Housekeeping, Security, Drivers, Canteen Staff	Permanent / Contractual
Contractual / Part-Time Staff	Guest Faculty, Part-Time Teachers, Visiting Experts, Project-Based Staff	Contractual

■ Probationary employees become eligible for Casual Leave and Sick Leave after completing their 6-month probation period. Earned Leave eligibility begins after 12 months of continuous service.

3. Leave Year & Accrual Calendar

The Leave Year at ABC International School follows the Academic Year, running from 01 April to 31 March of the following calendar year. All leave balances are refreshed at the beginning of each leave year, except Earned Leave which accrues monthly and may be carried forward subject to the rules in Section 8.

Month	Leave Activity	Action by HR
April	Leave year begins. CL & SL credited in full.	Upload balances to HRMS portal
April – May	Goal-setting for appraisal cycle. Leave planning discussion.	Send leave planning advisory

Month	Leave Activity	Action by HR
Every Month	EL accrues at 1.25 days/month for eligible staff.	Auto-credit in HRMS
October – November	Mid-year leave balance check.	Send balance statements to all staff
February	Self-appraisal period – leave should be minimal.	Issue advisory for examination season
March	Last month of leave year. Unused CL lapses on 31 March.	Send lapsing CL reminder
31 March	CL balance reset to zero. EL carry-forward calculated.	Finalise EL carry-forward records

4. Detailed Leave Entitlements – Teaching Staff

Teaching staff includes all classroom teachers (PRT, TGT, PGT), Subject Teachers, Specialist Teachers, Nursery & Pre-Primary Teachers, and Academic Coordinators / Heads of Departments. Entitlements below apply to confirmed (post-probation) permanent employees unless otherwise stated.

Leave Type	Days/Year	Eligibility	Carry-Forward	Encashable	Credit Method
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	After probation	No – lapses 31 Mar	No	Full credit on 01 Apr
Sick Leave (SL)	12 days	After probation	Max 15 days cumulative	No	Full credit on 01 Apr
Earned Leave (EL)	15 days	After 1 yr service	Max 45 days	Yes (at exit)	1.25 days/month
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	Female; 80 days worked in 12 months	N/A	No	On approved application
Paternity Leave	7 days	Male; within 6 months of childbirth	No	No	On application
Adoption Leave	12 weeks	Primary caregiver; child below 3 months	No	No	On application
Bereavement Leave	5 days	Immediate family*	No	No	On application
Compensatory Off	As earned	Working on declared holiday/weekend	Within 60 days	No	On HoD approval
Special Duty Leave	As approved	Official duty outside campus	N/A	No	Pre-approved by Principal
Leave Without Pay	Subject to approval	After exhausting all paid leaves	N/A	No	Principal + HR approval
Public Holidays	~17 days	All confirmed staff	N/A	No	School holiday calendar
Summer/Winter Vacation	As per academic calendar	Teaching staff (service condition)	N/A	No	Academic calendar

■ * Immediate family: Spouse, Children, Parents, Siblings, Parents-in-law.

■ Teaching staff required to attend school during summer/winter vacations for training, board work, exams or other duties will be compensated with equivalent Compensatory Off, to be availed within 60 days.

5. Detailed Leave Entitlements – Non-Teaching / Administrative Staff

Non-Teaching Staff includes Lab Assistants, Librarians, Counsellors, Sports Coaches, Activity Coordinators, and all Administrative cadres (Admissions, Accounts, HR, IT, Reception). Unlike teaching staff, non-teaching staff do not receive academic vacation leave and therefore receive a slightly higher Earned Leave entitlement.

Leave Type	Days/Year	Eligibility	Carry-Forward	Encashable	Credit Method
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	After probation	No – lapses 31 Mar	No	Full credit on 01 Apr
Sick Leave (SL)	12 days	After probation	Max 15 days cumulative	No	Full credit on 01 Apr
Earned Leave (EL)	21 days	After 1 yr service	Max 45 days	Yes (at exit)	1.75 days/month
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	Female; 80 days worked in 12 months	N/A	No	On approved application
Paternity Leave	7 days	Male; within 6 months of childbirth	No	No	On application
Adoption Leave	12 weeks	Primary caregiver; child below 3 months	No	No	On application
Bereavement Leave	5 days	Immediate family	No	No	On application
Compensatory Off	As earned	Working on declared holiday	Within 60 days	No	On supervisor approval
Leave Without Pay	Subject to approval	After all paid leaves exhausted	N/A	No	Principal + HR approval
Public Holidays	~17 days	All confirmed staff	N/A	No	School holiday calendar
Optional Holidays	2 days	Any 2 from approved optional list	No	No	Applied in advance

■ ■ Non-teaching staff working on public holidays (e.g., school events) must apply for Compensatory Off within 7 days. Unused CO lapses after 60 days and is not encashable.

6. Detailed Leave Entitlements – Contractual / Part-Time Staff

Contractual and part-time staff (guest faculty, visiting experts, project-based hires) have limited leave entitlements. Their contracts specify specific working days; absence on non-scheduled days does not count as leave.

Leave Type	Entitlement	Conditions
Casual Leave (CL)	4 days per contract year	No carry-forward; no encashment
Sick Leave (SL)	6 days per contract year	Medical certificate required for 2+ consecutive days
Maternity Leave	As per Maternity Benefit Act	Applicable if worked 80+ days in preceding 12 months
Paternity Leave	3 days	Within 1 month of childbirth; once per contract
Public Holidays	As per school calendar	Applicable on scheduled working days only
Leave Without Pay	Permitted with 7-day notice	Contract period extended proportionally only if agreed

■ ■ Contractual staff are not eligible for Earned Leave, Bereavement Leave or Compensatory Off unless explicitly stated in the individual contract.

7. Leave Type Master Reference Table

The following table provides a consolidated, side-by-side reference for all leave types across all staff categories.

Leave Type	Teaching	Acad. Lead.	Non-Teaching	Admin	Support	Contractual
Casual Leave (CL)	8	8	8	8	6	4
Sick Leave (SL)	12	12	12	12	10	6
Earned Leave (EL)	15	15	21	21	18	—
Maternity Leave	26 wks	26 wks	26 wks	26 wks	26 wks	Per Act
Paternity Leave	7	7	7	7	5	3
Adoption Leave	12 wks	12 wks	12 wks	12 wks	12 wks	—
Bereavement Leave	5	5	5	5	3	—
Compensatory Off	As earned	As earned	As earned	As earned	As earned	—
LWP (with approval)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Public Holidays	~17	~17	~17	~17	~17	~17 (sched.)
Summer/Winter Vacation	✓ (incl.)	✓ (incl.)	✗	✗	✗	✗
Optional Holidays	—	—	2	2	—	—

■ All figures represent calendar days per leave year unless noted as 'weeks'. Dashes (—) indicate the leave type is not applicable. Academic vacation (summer/winter) for teaching staff is a service condition, not counted against leave.

8. Leave Accrual, Carry-Forward & Encashment Rules

8.1 Casual Leave (CL)

- CL is credited in full (8 days) at the start of the academic year on 01 April.
- Employees joining mid-year receive CL on a pro-rata basis: $(\text{remaining months} \div 12) \times 8$, rounded up.
- Maximum 3 CL days may be taken consecutively without special approval.
- CL cannot be combined with any other leave type except in exceptional circumstances approved by the Principal.
- Unused CL at the end of the leave year (31 March) lapses and is neither carried forward nor encashed.
- CL is not applicable during Summer/Winter vacations for teaching staff.

8.2 Sick Leave (SL)

- SL is credited in full (12 days) at the start of the academic year on 01 April.
- A medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner is mandatory for SL of 3 or more consecutive days.
- SL cannot be taken on the day immediately preceding or following a public holiday or school holiday without a medical certificate.
- Unused SL is carried forward up to a maximum cumulative balance of 15 days.
- SL is not encashable under any circumstances.
- SL taken without a valid medical certificate (where required) may be converted to CL or LWP at HR's discretion.

8.3 Earned Leave (EL)

- EL accrues monthly: 1.25 days/month for teaching staff; 1.75 days/month for non-teaching/administrative staff.
- Accrual begins after completion of 12 months of continuous service. No EL during probation.

- Maximum carry-forward is 45 days. Accrual beyond 45 days is forfeited unless encashment has been applied for.
- EL can be encashed (up to 30 days at a time) once per year, in April, at the request of the employee.
- At resignation or retirement, all accumulated EL (up to the 45-day cap) is encashed at the last drawn basic salary rate.
- EL requires a minimum 7-day advance notice for planned leave.
- During the notice period, EL cannot be adjusted unless mutually agreed with HR and the reporting manager.

8.4 Encashment Summary

Leave Type	Encashable?	When	Max Days	Rate
Casual Leave (CL)	NO	—	—	—
Sick Leave (SL)	NO	—	—	—
Earned Leave (EL) – In-Service	YES	Once per year (April)	30 days	Basic salary ÷ 26 × days
Earned Leave (EL) – On Exit	YES	Full & Final Settlement	Up to 45 days	Basic salary ÷ 26 × days
Compensatory Off	NO	—	—	Lapses after 60 days
Maternity / Paternity	NO	—	—	—

9. Leave Application & Approval Workflow

9.1 Advance Notice Requirements

Leave Type	Advance Notice Required	Who Approves	Final Authority
Casual Leave (1–2 days)	1 working day in advance	Immediate Supervisor	Head of Department
Casual Leave (3+ days)	3 working days in advance	Head of Department	Principal
Sick Leave (planned)	As early as possible	Immediate Supervisor	Head of Department
Sick Leave (emergency)	Inform by 8:00 AM on day of absence	Supervisor (retroactive)	HR Department
Earned Leave (up to 5 days)	7 working days in advance	Head of Department	Principal
Earned Leave (6+ days)	15 working days in advance	Head of Department	Principal
Maternity / Paternity Leave	8 weeks before expected date	HR Department	Principal
Bereavement Leave	Inform ASAP; apply within 2 days of return	Immediate Supervisor	HR Department
Leave Without Pay	30 working days in advance	HR Department	Principal (written order)
Compensatory Off	3 working days in advance	Immediate Supervisor	Head of Department

9.2 Step-by-Step Application Process

Step 1 – Check Balance: Log into the HRMS portal (hrms.abcschool.edu.in) and verify current leave balance. Alternatively, contact HR directly.

Step 2 – Complete Application: Fill the Leave Application Form online via the HRMS portal, or obtain a physical form from HR. Specify leave type, dates, and reason.

Step 3 – Arrange Substitution: For teaching staff, arrange a substitute lesson plan in advance and hand over to the Head of Department.

Step 4 – Submit to Supervisor: Submit the application to your immediate supervisor for primary approval. Teaching staff must additionally submit lesson plans.

Step 5 – HoD / Principal Approval: The supervisor forwards the approved application to the Head of Department or Principal as per the approval matrix above.

Step 6 – HR Processing: Approved applications are processed by HR, leave balance is debited, and the record is updated in HRMS.

Step 7 – Confirmation: Employee receives an automated email confirmation from the HRMS portal once leave is approved and recorded.

Step 8 – Return from Leave: On return, mark attendance in the biometric system. If SL was for 3+ days, submit the medical certificate to HR immediately.

9.3 Emergency / Unplanned Leave

In case of emergency (sudden illness, family emergency), the employee must inform their immediate supervisor by phone or WhatsApp before 8:00 AM on the day of absence. The formal leave application must be submitted on the first working day after return. Failure to inform within 2 hours of school start time may result in the day being treated as Unauthorised Absence and subject to LWP deduction.

10. Special Circumstances & Extended Leave

Medical / Hospitalisation Leave

If an employee requires extended medical leave beyond the available SL balance, the remaining period will first be adjusted against CL, then EL, and finally treated as LWP. A medical certificate from a specialist and a fit-to-return certificate are mandatory.

Critical Illness (Self or Immediate Family)

Up to 30 days of additional LWP may be sanctioned for critical illness of the employee or a dependent. Supported by hospital records. Approved by Principal with HR concurrence.

Accident / Disability

An employee injured in an accident while on official school duty is covered under the Employees' Compensation Act. HR will initiate the ESI/insurance claim process. Work-related disability leave is treated as Special Duty Leave and does not affect the regular leave balance.

Study Leave / Higher Education

Permanent employees with 3+ years of service may apply for Study Leave (treated as LWP) for pursuing higher education relevant to their role. A minimum 6-month advance notice is required. A bond of equivalent service post-study completion may be required at the Principal's discretion.

Community / National Service

Leave for jury service, election duty, or any other mandated public/national service will be treated as Special Duty Leave (paid) with documentary proof. Not counted against leave balance.

11. Leave Without Pay (LWP) Policy

Leave Without Pay is a special category of leave granted only when all other paid leave options have been exhausted or when the nature of the request falls outside the scope of paid leave entitlements.

- LWP requires prior written approval from both the Principal and HR Head. Verbal or WhatsApp approvals are NOT sufficient.
- Employees are not entitled to LWP as a right. Each application is considered on its individual merits.
- LWP beyond 30 consecutive days may impact PF contributions, gratuity calculations, and annual increment eligibility.
- LWP shall not exceed 90 days in any leave year. Any extension beyond this requires a Board-level approval.
- Salary deduction for LWP: $(\text{Gross Monthly Salary} \div 26 \text{ working days}) \times \text{Number of LWP Days}$.
- LWP during the probation period may result in extension of the probation by the equivalent number of days.
- Unauthorised absence will be treated as LWP and may additionally attract disciplinary action.

12. Statutory Leaves – Maternity, Paternity & Adoption

12.1 Maternity Leave

Governing Law	Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (amended 2017)
Total Duration	26 weeks (182 days) for first two children; 12 weeks for third child onwards
Pre-Natal Leave	Up to 8 weeks may be taken before the expected date of delivery
Post-Natal Leave	Remaining weeks after delivery
Eligibility Condition	Worked for a minimum of 80 days in the 12 months preceding expected delivery date
Miscarriage / Medical Termination	6 weeks of paid leave with medical documentation
Tubectomy / Other Illness	2 weeks of paid leave following the procedure, with medical certificate
Nursing Break	Two nursing breaks per day (15 min each) for up to 15 months after delivery; not counted as absence
Work-From-Home (WFH) Option	Available post-ML for up to 4 weeks, subject to role suitability and Principal's approval
Documentation Required	Medical certificate from gynaecologist; hospital records; application 8 weeks before expected date
Salary During ML	Full salary (all components) paid throughout the leave period
Encashment	Not applicable; ML is not encashable

12.2 Paternity Leave

Duration	7 days (teaching & senior non-teaching staff); 5 days (support staff); 3 days (contractual)
Eligibility Window	Must be availed within 6 months of childbirth or adoption; non-transferable
Applicability	Biological or legally adoptive father; once per child (up to two children)
Salary During Leave	Full salary paid
Documentation	Birth certificate (submitted within 30 days); hospital discharge summary
Combination	May be combined with CL for an extended period with supervisor approval

12.3 Adoption Leave

Permanent employees who legally adopt a child below 3 months of age are entitled to 12 weeks of paid Adoption Leave. The primary caregiver (of either gender) receives the full 12 weeks; the secondary caregiver receives 7 days. Legal adoption order / court documents are mandatory. This leave is available for the first two adopted

children only.

13. Compensatory Off (CO) Policy

Compensatory Off is granted when an employee is required to work on a declared School Holiday, Public Holiday, or weekend (Saturday / Sunday) for official school purposes.

- CO must be pre-approved by the Head of Department before the holiday/weekend duty is undertaken.
- CO entitlement is on a 1:1 basis — one holiday worked = one CO day earned.
- Half-day duty on a holiday earns half-day CO.
- CO must be availed within 60 calendar days of being earned. It lapses thereafter.
- CO application must be submitted to HR within 7 working days of working the holiday.
- CO cannot be accumulated; maximum 5 CO days may be held at any one time.
- CO is not encashable under any circumstances.
- Teaching staff conducting board exam duties on holidays are entitled to CO; managed via the exam duty roster.
- CO availed during critical periods (exam time, admissions) requires Principal's approval even if earned earlier.

14. Leave During Critical School Periods

Certain periods of the academic year are operationally critical and leave during these periods is generally not encouraged or may be restricted.

Period	Approx. Dates	Leave Restrictions	Exception
Board Examination Period (Class X & XII)	Feb – Mar	CL and EL strongly discouraged for exam duty staff	Medical emergency + medical certificate only
Annual Examination Period (Class I–IX, XI)	March	CL restricted; EL not approved	Bereavement + medical emergency only
Result Preparation & Declaration	April (first 2 weeks)	All leave restricted for teaching staff	Medical emergency only
Admission Season	March – June	Admin staff leave restricted	Bereavement + medical emergency only
School Annual Day / Events	Date-specific	Event coordinators – no leave	As approved by Principal
Parent-Teacher Meeting Days	As per calendar	Class teachers – no leave	Medical emergency only
CBSE / Cambridge Submission Deadlines	As per board calendar	Relevant dept. staff – no leave	As approved by Principal

■ ■ Any leave taken during the above periods without prior approval will be treated as Unauthorised Absence and will be deducted as LWP with potential disciplinary implications.

15. Attendance Impact & Payroll Deduction Rules

Leave and attendance are directly linked to payroll. All deductions are computed based on the biometric attendance system records and approved leave in the HRMS.

Scenario	Payroll Treatment	Calculation
Approved CL / SL / EL within balance	No salary deduction	Full month salary paid
Approved LWP	Proportional deduction	Gross Salary ÷ 26 × LWP days

Scenario	Payroll Treatment	Calculation
Unauthorised Absence	LWP deduction + disciplinary note	Gross Salary ÷ 26 × absent days
Late Arrival (≤3 times/month)	No deduction; verbal warning	Attendance recorded; noted in appraisal
Late Arrival (4–6 times/month)	Written warning; no deduction	HR counselling initiated
Late Arrival (7+ times/month)	Half-day leave deduction per instance	CL debited; if no CL balance, LWP applies
Early Departure (unapproved)	Half-day leave deduction	CL debited; if no CL, LWP applies
Leave encashment (EL)	Credited with April salary	Basic ÷ 26 × encashed days added to salary
Excess leave (beyond balance)	Automatically treated as LWP	Deducted from subsequent month salary

■■ Payslips are available on the HRMS portal by the 10th of every month. For discrepancies, raise a ticket on the HRMS portal or contact HR within 15 days of payslip issuance.

16. Leave Records & HRMS Portal Guidance

All leave applications, approvals, balance statements and encashment requests are managed through the school's HR Management System (HRMS). Physical forms are available as a backup in case of system downtime. Login at: hrms.abcschool.edu.in — use your Employee ID and HRMS password.

View Leave Balance	Dashboard → My Leaves → Leave Balance. Updated in real-time after each approval.
Apply for Leave	Dashboard → My Leaves → Apply Leave → Select type, dates, reason → Attach documents → Submit.
Track Leave Status	Dashboard → My Leaves → Leave History. Status updates: Pending / Approved / Rejected / Cancelled.
Download Leave Statement	My Leaves → Leave Statement → Select period → Download PDF.
Apply for EL Encashment	My Leaves → EL Encashment Request (visible in April only) → Enter number of days → Submit.
Attendance Regularisation	My Attendance → Regularisation Request → Enter date, time, reason → Supervisor approval required.
Report a System Issue	Help & Support → Raise Ticket → Category: HRMS Portal Issue. HR will resolve within 2 working days.

17. Policy Violations & Disciplinary Action

Violation	First Instance	Repeat / Serious Offence
Absence without intimation	LWP deduction + verbal warning	Written warning + escalation to Principal
Submitting false medical certificate	Written warning + LWP conversion	Termination proceedings initiated
Misrepresenting leave reason	Written warning + LWP conversion	Disciplinary committee review
Availing leave during restricted period without approval	LWP deduction + warning letter	Adverse remark in annual appraisal
Exceeding approved leave duration	Excess days treated as LWP	LWP + written warning
Proxy attendance (biometric fraud)	Show-cause notice + suspension of leave balance	Termination; police complaint if warranted
Leave encashment fraud	Immediate recovery + written warning	Termination + legal action

■■ All disciplinary decisions are made in accordance with Natural Justice principles — the employee will be given an opportunity to present their case before a final decision is taken.

18. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

18.1 General Leave FAQs

Q: How many paid leaves do I get per year?

A: Confirmed teaching staff receive 8 CL + 12 SL + 15 EL (accrued) = 35 paid leave days per year, plus approximately 17 public holidays and academic vacation periods. Non-teaching/administrative staff receive 8 CL + 12 SL + 21 EL = 41 paid leave days plus ~17 public holidays.

Q: Can I take leave during my probation period?

A: Probationary employees are not entitled to CL or SL during the probation period. Any absence during probation is treated as LWP unless it is a public holiday. Probation does not accrue Earned Leave; EL accrual begins only after 12 months of confirmed service.

Q: Can I combine different types of leave?

A: Yes. For example, you may combine SL with CL or EL for extended medical situations. Certain combinations (e.g., CL adjacent to a public holiday on both sides) may require special approval.

Q: What is the maximum number of days I can take at a stretch?

A: CL: maximum 3 consecutive days without HoD approval, up to 8 with HoD+Principal approval. EL: up to 30 days at a stretch with advance notice. Combined leave: up to 45 days with Principal approval; beyond that requires Board awareness.

Q: What happens to my leave if I resign?

A: On resignation, all unused CL and SL are forfeited. Accumulated EL (up to 45 days) is encashed at the basic salary rate as part of the Full & Final Settlement, processed within 30–45 days of the last working day.

18.2 Casual Leave FAQs

Q: Can I use CL for personal errands or family events?

A: Yes. CL is intended for short-notice personal matters including family events, personal errands, or unforeseen circumstances. No reason documentation is required for 1–2 days of CL.

Q: Can I take CL on a Monday or Friday?

A: CL taken immediately adjacent to a weekend (Friday+Monday extension) for 2+ days requires HoD approval. Repeated patterns of Friday/Monday CL will be reviewed and may be disallowed.

Q: My CL balance is zero but I need one more day — what are my options?

A: If CL is exhausted, the absence will be adjusted against SL (if applicable) or EL balance. If no balance remains, it will be treated as LWP. Discuss with HR before taking the day off.

18.3 Sick Leave FAQs

Q: Do I need a medical certificate for 1 day of sick leave?

A: A medical certificate is not required for 1–2 days of SL. For 3 or more consecutive days, a certificate from a registered medical practitioner is mandatory and must be submitted on the first day of return.

Q: My sick leave balance is 0 but I am unwell — what do I do?

A: Inform your supervisor immediately. HR will first adjust against CL, then EL. If all balances are zero, the absence will be treated as LWP.

Q: Can I accumulate sick leave indefinitely?

A: No. SL carry-forward is capped at 15 days. Any SL above this cap at the end of the leave year is forfeited.

18.4 Earned Leave FAQs

Q: When exactly does my EL start accruing?

A: EL accrual begins from the 13th month of continuous, confirmed service. For example, if you joined on 01 June 2024 and confirmed on 01 December 2024, EL begins accruing from 01 June 2025.

Q: Can I check my EL balance online?

A: Yes. Log into the HRMS portal → My Leaves → Leave Balance. You can see CL, SL, EL, and CO balances in real time.

Q: I want to encash my EL — how do I apply?

A: EL encashment is available once per year in April. Log into HRMS → My Leaves → EL Encashment Request. Maximum 30 days can be encashed per request. Encashment is paid with the April salary.

Q: Can I take EL during my notice period?

A: EL cannot be adjusted against the notice period unless HR and the reporting manager mutually agree. Availing EL without approval during the notice period may result in salary recovery for the notice shortfall.

18.5 Maternity & Paternity Leave FAQs

Q: How do I apply for maternity leave?

A: Submit a written application to HR at least 8 weeks before the expected date of delivery, along with a medical certificate from your gynaecologist. HR will confirm the leave dates and payroll arrangements in writing.

Q: Am I paid my full salary during maternity leave?

A: Yes. The Maternity Benefit Act mandates full salary payment during the 26-week ML period. All salary components (basic, HRA, all allowances) are paid. PF contributions by employer and employee continue during this period.

Q: Can maternity leave be extended?

A: After 26 weeks, the employee may apply for LWP or use any remaining EL. Additionally, the school offers up to 4 weeks of WFH (subject to role suitability) as an extension support measure.

Q: I am a male employee — am I entitled to leave when my child is born?

A: Yes. Male employees (teaching staff and senior non-teaching staff) receive 7 days of paid Paternity Leave, to be availed within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption. Support staff receive 5 days.

18.6 Leave Policy Administration FAQs

Q: Who should I contact if my leave is rejected unfairly?

A: First discuss with your immediate supervisor. If unresolved, escalate to the HR Department in writing (hr@abcschool.edu.in). If still unresolved, submit a formal grievance per the Employee Handbook Section 13.3. The Principal gives the final decision.

Q: Can HR or the Principal cancel an already approved leave?

A: In exceptional operational circumstances (e.g., sudden staff shortage, critical examination), approved leave may be recalled. The employee will be given as much notice as possible and the leave will be rescheduled at the earliest opportunity.

Q: I forgot to mark my attendance but was present — what do I do?

A: Submit an Attendance Regularisation Request on the HRMS portal within 3 working days. Your supervisor must approve the regularisation. Repeated requests (more than twice a month) may be treated as negligence.

Q: Does leave affect my annual increment?

A: Excessive unauthorised absence or frequent LWP may be noted in the annual appraisal and could impact the increment. SL, CL, and EL availed within entitlement limits do not negatively affect increments.

19. Appendix – Quick Reference Cards by Staff Category

19.1 Teaching Staff Quick Reference

Leave Type	Days	Carry-Forward	Documents Needed	Approving Authority
Casual Leave (CL)	8/year	None (lapses 31 Mar)	None (for 1–2 days)	HoD
Sick Leave (SL)	12/year	Up to 15 days	Med cert (3+ consec. days)	Supervisor → HR
Earned Leave (EL)	1.25 days/month	Up to 45 days	Prior application, 7+ days notice	HoD → Principal
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	N/A	Gynaecologist cert, 8 wks notice	HR → Principal
Paternity Leave	7 days	No	Birth cert (within 30 days)	HR
Bereavement Leave	5 days	No	Death cert / hospital record	Supervisor → HR
Compensatory Off	As earned	60 days	CO request within 7 days of holiday worked	Supervisor → HoD
LWP	As approved	N/A	Written request + all leaves exhausted	HR → Principal

19.2 Non-Teaching & Administrative Staff Quick Reference

Leave Type	Days	Carry-Forward	Documents Needed	Approving Authority
Casual Leave (CL)	8/year	None (lapses 31 Mar)	None (for 1–2 days)	Supervisor
Sick Leave (SL)	12/year	Up to 15 days	Med cert (3+ consec. days)	Supervisor → HR
Earned Leave (EL)	1.75 days/month	Up to 45 days	Prior application, 7+ days notice	HoD → Principal
Optional Holidays	2/year	None	Advance application from approved list	Supervisor
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	N/A	Gynaecologist cert, 8 wks notice	HR → Principal
Paternity Leave	7 days	No	Birth cert (within 30 days)	HR
Bereavement Leave	5 days	No	Death cert / hospital record	Supervisor → HR
Compensatory Off	As earned	60 days	CO request within 7 days	Supervisor
LWP	As approved	N/A	Written request + all leaves exhausted	HR → Principal

19.3 Contractual & Part-Time Staff Quick Reference

Leave Type	Days	Conditions
Casual Leave (CL)	4/contract year	No carry-forward; no encashment
Sick Leave (SL)	6/contract year	Med cert for 2+ consecutive days
Maternity Leave	Per Maternity Benefit Act	If worked 80+ days in preceding 12 months
Paternity Leave	3 days	Within 1 month of childbirth

Leave Type	Days	Conditions
Public Holidays	As per school calendar	Applicable on scheduled working days only
LWP	With 7-day notice	No paid leave balance needed; period may not extend contract

20. Glossary of Terms

Academic Year / Leave Year	01 April to 31 March. All leave balances reset at the start of this period.
Accrual	The process by which EL is earned incrementally over time (1.25 or 1.75 days per month).
Bereavement Leave	Paid leave granted upon the death of an immediate family member.
Carry-Forward	Unused leave balance transferred to the next leave year (applicable to SL and EL only).
Casual Leave (CL)	Short-notice paid leave for unforeseen or personal matters; 8 days per year.
CO (Compensatory Off)	A substitute day off earned when working on a declared holiday or weekend.
Confirmed Employee	An employee who has successfully completed the 6-month probation period.
Earned Leave (EL)	Paid leave that accrues monthly for all confirmed employees; encashable.
EL Encashment	Converting accumulated EL into a cash payment, applicable once annually in April.
HRMS	Human Resources Management System — the school's online portal for leave and HR management.
Immediate Family	Spouse, Children (biological or legally adopted), Parents, Siblings, Parents-in-law.
Leave Without Pay (LWP)	Approved absence where no salary is paid; granted only when all paid leave is exhausted.
Maternity Leave (ML)	Statutory paid leave of 26 weeks for female employees during pregnancy/childbirth.
Notice Period	3 months for teaching staff; 1 month for non-teaching staff.
Paternity Leave (PL)	Paid leave for male employees (7 days) upon birth or adoption of a child.
Pro-Rata	Proportional calculation of leave based on the fraction of the leave year remaining at joining.
Probation Period	Initial 6 months of employment during which full leave entitlements do not apply.
Sick Leave (SL)	Paid leave for illness or medical treatment; 12 days per year; medical cert required for 3+ days.
Unauthorised Absence	Absence without prior approval or intimation; treated as LWP and may attract disciplinary action.

Document Control Notice: This document is issued by the HR Department of ABC International School, Powai. It supersedes all previous versions of the Leave Policy. The policy is reviewed annually and updated as required by changes in legislation or school operational needs. In case of any conflict between this document and applicable law, the law shall prevail. Employees are encouraged to contact the HR Department for any clarifications. Last reviewed: 05 June 2026.